

TikTok

Read [README.md](#) first — it has the link format and the link test that this guide assumes you have done.

1. TikTok cannot be used from India

The Government of India blocked TikTok in June 2020 and the block is still in force. In August 2025 the government publicly denied reports that it had been lifted, and no order lifting it has been issued since.

For a client advertising in India this means:

- No TikTok account, TikTok Ads Manager account, or TikTok Business Centre.

- No ad spend, and no TikTok traffic to the property page.

- Using a VPN or a foreign entity to reach TikTok is a circumvention of the block, not a workaround. Do not do it, and do not build a process that assumes someone will.

This was confirmed while writing this guide: TikTok's own domains refuse connections from an Indian network, including its advertiser help centre and its developer documentation.

If the client only advertises in India, stop here. The rest of this guide applies to a different market and should not be acted on.

The CRM already accepts TikTok's `ttclid` click parameter and can classify `utm_source=tiktok`. That support is unused and costs nothing to keep, so no code change is needed if TikTok ever becomes available.

2. If you advertise from a market where TikTok is available

Confirm two things before spending any time on setup:

- TikTok advertising is legally available in the advertiser's country **and** in the country you want to show ads in.

- TikTok accepts real-estate advertising in that market. Some markets require licence or registration details before a housing ad is approved.

Both are answered in TikTok Ads Manager for that specific account, not from documentation. If either is unclear, do not proceed.

3. Accounts

Create the TikTok account the ads will be published from, and complete the profile — name, photo, bio, and website.

Create a TikTok Business Centre owned by the client's business.

Create the advertiser (ad) account inside the Business Centre, choosing the correct country, currency, and time zone. **These cannot be changed later** — an error here means starting over with a new account.

Complete business verification. TikTok asks for registration documents, and unverified accounts hit limits.

Link the TikTok account as an identity so ads can run under it.

Add each person with their own login and the least access they need.

Add the payment method.

4. Organic posts

TikTok captions do not produce a clickable link for most accounts. A URL in a caption is text. Some accounts have a website field on the profile; where that exists, put the property link there, exactly as built in [README.md](#), with `utm_source=tiktok`.

Treat organic TikTok as awareness. The reliable path from TikTok to the CRM is a paid ad with a destination URL.

5. Run a Traffic ad

TikTok Ads Manager has three levels: campaign (objective and budget), ad group (audience, placement, schedule, bidding), and ad (creative and destination URL).

If offered a choice between **Simplified Mode** and **Custom Mode**, choose Custom Mode. Simplified Mode hides the placement and destination controls this setup depends on.

Campaign

Objective: **Traffic**. It optimises for clicks through to a destination URL and needs no pixel.

Name it with the campaign key that is in your link.

Set the budget and either an end date or a named person responsible for stopping it.

Ad group

Placement: select TikTok only. TikTok's other placements have different audiences and rules.

Set the locations, schedule, and any audience settings the market's housing rules allow.

Leave off any setting that requires the TikTok Pixel, including anything optimising for on-site actions. No pixel is installed.

Optimisation goal: clicks.

Ad

Upload the video or images. Vertical, full-screen, and captioned.

Write the ad text so it agrees with the property page on price, availability, and location.

Call to action: something factual such as **Learn more**.

Destination URL: paste the complete link with all parameters.

If TikTok offers to append its own URL parameters, leave that empty. Your link already has them.

Preview the ad, click through, and confirm the property page loads with all four `utm_` values intact. TikTok may add `ttclid`; the CRM handles it.

Submit for review.

6. After launch

Run the link test from the live ad preview on a real phone, including TikTok's in-app browser. Confirm the enquiry arrives with source `tiktok` and the expected campaign key, and that the email reached every recipient.

7. Problems

What you see	Cause	Fix
TikTok Ads Manager will not open or the account cannot be created	The market is blocked or unsupported	Do not attempt to bypass it
Ad rejected	Real-estate or housing policy in that market	Read the rejection reason; supply licence details if requested
CRM source shows unknown	utm_source misspelled	It must be exactly tiktok , lowercase
Clicks reported but no enquiries	The destination is broken in the in-app browser, or the link lost its parameters	Retest from the live ad on a phone
Instant Form leads are not in the CRM	That path does not exist	Pause the campaign; download the leads from Ads Manager

8. Instant Forms

TikTok Instant Forms keep leads inside TikTok. Nothing has been built to collect them. TikTok also holds lead data in Ads Manager for a limited period only, so a form left running without an integration will eventually lose leads that were never downloaded. Confirm the current retention window in your account before relying on manual export. See [native-lead-forms.md](#).

Sources and verification limits

TikTok's advertiser help centre ([ads.tiktok.com](#)) and developer portal ([business-api.tiktok.com](#) , [developers.tiktok.com](#)) were unreachable from the network used to write this guide, which is consistent with the Indian block. The steps above therefore come from current secondary documentation of TikTok Ads Manager and were not confirmed against a TikTok page.

Treat every navigation step in sections 3 to 5 as unverified and check it in the account before use. Sections 1 and 2 — the India block and the market gate — are the parts that matter for this client, and those are confirmed:

[Government of India press release, 29 June 2020](#) — the original blocking order listing TikTok
[No order issued to lift the ban on TikTok in India](#) — government statement, August 2025
